

More Core

AMD claims their server customers prefer processors with more cores in them

Sony PSP2

Game developers have got their hands on the new PSP2

aspects. But it cannot compare with a standard DSLR camera. Also the variety of lens available for the micro four thirds is limited as of this day. Price-wise they are more expensive than entry-level DSLRs. The main advantage they have is compact size and a major disappointment is the absence of a view finder. Lets face it, it is unusual to look through a screen and adjust the lens.

Should you buy this now? If you want a compact DSLR and are not going to use many lenses in the near future then yes, go for it. If you already have a standard DSLR with a range of lenses, then unless you are looking at a compact form factor, avoid it.

Only Olympus (three) and Panasonic (five) have camera models in this segment.

THE HYPE

Social network tagging is a new feature which allows user to tag photos and videos and upload to sites like Facebook or YouTube, such that while transferring images to the system, the tagged images and videos will be optimised to be uploaded to the sites. The software bundled along with the camera will automatically ask if you want to upload the photos and videos. This definitely saves a lot of time, but it makes sense to spend additional bucks on this feature only if you are a heavy user of these sites.



3D Cameras like Fujifilm Finepix Real 3D W1 should be avoided as of now

Otherwise using traditional methods like saving the images on the system then uploading manually suffice. Price points to look at should be ₹15,000.

A lot of manufacturers are coming out with cameras with **Wi-Fi and Bluetooth** capability. These cameras not only allow

you to transfer images to your system over a Wi-Fi connection, but also allow you to upload images directly to Flickr, Facebook and videos to YouTube.

This is the way to go. But again we would advise you to wait and let more players come out with these type of cam-

eras. However, expect to pay more as this is currently a premium feature.

Fujifilm had come out with a 3D camera called the FinePix Real 3D W1, that shoots 3D images and videos. We think it's too early to invest in a 3D digital camera, as the 3D eco system (displays especially) are hard to come by. Nikon Coolpix S1100pj is a compact camera with a **mini projector** inbuilt. These niche features are welcome innovations, but we would advise waiting for at least a year before buying anything like this. Two reasons: let more manufacturers start adding these, to see if it's a viable trend, and secondly, prices will fall.

DSLR and Lens

Buying a DSLR requires some homework on your end. Apart from the present cost of purchasing a DSLR body with the standard lens, you will also have to ask yourself if you are willing to invest in lenses in the near future. Camera lenses are expensive, so if you plan on doing wildlife or sports photography, then you will not only have to buy a DSLR body, but also invest substantial amount of

money in a compatible lens. Buying a DSLR is not just a one-time purchase. You are also buying into a whole eco system of compatible

lenses, flash guns and other accessories. So be doubly sure before buying a DSLR about all these external factors.

Latest or Slightly older?

Also while purchasing a DSLR, it is all right to opt for models that are a generation older, as long as you get after-sales service. Unless newer models have some drastic changes in the features, you can save money by buying an older camera that offers you 90 per cent of the features, and often comparable performance at a bigger drop in price. For instance, it makes sense to buy a Canon 550D over its predecessor the Canon EOS40D, since the 550D has significantly improved the image sensor, added HD recording, higher ISO range, higher exposure ratings, etc. In the ultrazooms, however, the newer models are priced substantially higher than older models, but the additions are minimal.



Sony DSC TX-1 for Entry level compact

RECOMMENDATIONS

We will only be recommending cameras that we've tested previously, so although not comprehensive of the market reality, we prefer to be sure when talking about cameras.

Entry level point and shoot: Samsung ST550, Sony DSC TX1.

Ultrazooms : Panasonic DMC-TZ10, Canon IXUS 130IS, Nikon P100,

Micro Four Thirds : Samsung NX11 and Olympus PEN E-P1

Entry level DSLRs : Canon 550D and Nikon D3000

High-end DSLRS : Canon 7D and Nikon D300S, Nikon D90

Ultra High-end DSLR : Nikon D3s

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